

NietoCity

Educational Mode: Explain Card Content

Created by Nieto Software

This is the reference text for NietoCity's Explain cards. When Explain mode is on, a short card like these appears as the player selects a tool, opens an overlay, or views a city problem. The wording is grounded in how the Micropolis engine actually behaves. Money is shown in South African rand (R). Costs are the engine's tool costs. Edit any card freely; Claude Code should build the shared card registry from this content, one entry per tool, overlay and problem, plus the four basics at the end.

Tools

Tool	Cost	What it is	How it works
Bulldozer	R1	Clears land back to bare ground.	Levels trees, rubble, buildings and shallow water edges. You must bulldoze the rubble left by a fire or demolition before you can build on that spot again.
Power line (Wire)	R5	Carries electricity across the map.	Zones only grow when powered. Power flows through connected wires and between zones that touch, but NOT along roads, so run a wire to any zone that is not already on the grid. Wire over water costs more.
Road	R10	The streets citizens drive on.	Every zone needs a road within about three tiles or it will not develop. Heavy traffic, though, adds pollution and slows the city, so plan routes rather than paving everywhere.
Rail	R20	A railway, an alternative to roads.	Rail moves citizens like roads do but without the same traffic build-up, useful for busy corridors. It costs more to lay and to maintain.
Residential zone	R100	Where people live (the R zones).	Grows when it has power, a road nearby and residential demand (the RES bar). Pollution, crime or a lack of jobs will keep it empty.
Commercial zone	R100	Shops and offices (the C zones).	Grows on commercial demand, which needs both residents to shop and industry to supply. Needs power and road access like every zone.
Industrial zone	R100	Factories (the I zones).	Grows on industrial demand and provides the first jobs, so it drives early growth, but it is the biggest source of pollution. Keep it away from homes.
Fire station	R500	A fire department.	Within its coverage, fires start less often and are put out faster. Its strength depends on the fire-funding percentage in the Budget. See the Fire coverage overlay for its reach.
Police station	R500	A police department.	Crime falls inside its coverage, which grows with the police-funding percentage in the Budget. Dense, low-value areas breed crime, so place stations there. See the Police coverage overlay.
Stadium	R5000	A sports stadium.	Once residential population passes a certain size it stops growing until the city has a stadium. A milestone building, not needed early.
Park	R10	A small green space.	Raises the land value of nearby tiles and slightly

Tool	Cost	What it is	How it works
			cleans the air, which draws growth and lowers crime. A cheap way to lift a struggling neighbourhood.
Seaport	R3000	A harbour on the coast.	Industrial zones stop growing past a point until the city has a seaport. Build it on a water edge once industry is established.
Coal power plant	R3000	A coal-fired power station.	Supplies power to every zone connected by wires or touching it. Cheap to build but a heavy polluter, so site it away from homes.
Nuclear power plant	R5000	A nuclear power station.	Far more power than coal with almost no pollution, but it can suffer a meltdown that irradiates the land around it for a long time. Costlier to build.
Airport	R10000	An airport.	Commercial zones stop growing past a point until the city has an airport. Expensive, only worth it in a large city, and the aeroplanes it brings can occasionally crash.
Query	free	The information tool.	Tap any tile to read its details: zone type, density, land value, crime, pollution and growth rate. It builds nothing and costs nothing.

Data overlays

Overlay	What it shows, and how to read it
Population density	Where people are concentrated. Denser areas demand more services and generate more traffic and crime.
Pollution	Air pollution, highest around industry, heavy traffic, power plants and the airport. High pollution lowers land value and stops zones growing.
Crime	The crime rate, worst in dense, low-value areas far from police. High crime empties residential and commercial zones.
Land value	How desirable each tile is. Rises near parks, water and the centre; falls with pollution and crime. High value draws growth and tax income.
Traffic	Road congestion. Heavy traffic slows the city and adds pollution; spread destinations or add rail to relieve it.
Power grid	Which tiles are powered. Unpowered zones never grow; use it to find gaps in your wires after adding a plant.
Fire coverage	How well fire stations reach each area. Gaps are where fires spread; the reach grows with fire funding in the Budget.
Police coverage	How well police reach each area. Gaps are where crime climbs; the reach grows with police funding in the Budget.

City problems (Evaluation)

These are the concerns citizens raise in the Evaluation screen. Each card names the cause and the fix.

Problem	Why it happens	How to fix it
Crime	Dense, low-value areas with too little police coverage.	Add police stations, raise police funding, and lift land value with parks and lower density.
Pollution	Industry, heavy traffic, coal power and	Separate industry from homes, favour rail and

Problem	Why it happens	How to fix it
	the airport.	nuclear or spread things out, and add parks.
Housing	Residential demand outstripping the homes available.	Zone more residential land, each with power and road access.
Taxes	The tax rate is set too high.	Lower the tax rate in the Budget, balancing it against the services you can still afford.
Traffic	Too many trips funnelled onto too few routes.	Add roads and especially rail, and place jobs nearer to homes.
Unemployment	Too little commercial and industrial zoning for the population.	Zone more industry and commerce, with power and roads, so residents can work.
Fire	Areas beyond fire-station coverage, worse with dense growth and disasters.	Add fire stations to cover the gaps and raise fire funding.

The four basics

Power. Every zone needs electricity to grow. Build a power plant, then run power lines to your zones; power also passes between zones that touch. A zone with no power blinks a lightning bolt and stays empty. Roads do not carry power.

Road access. Every zone needs a road (or rail) within a few tiles, or citizens cannot reach it and it will not develop. Connect each new zone to your network as you build.

Demand (RCI). The city grows on three demands: Residential, Commercial and Industrial, shown as the RCI bars. Industry and commerce create the jobs that draw residents; residents and industry create the trade that grows commerce. Zone more of whatever demand is high; a negative demand means you have too much of that type.

Money and tax. You collect tax each year from your population and land value, set by the tax rate in the Budget. Higher taxes raise income but annoy citizens, and funding for roads, police and fire also comes from the Budget; underfunding them lets the city decay.

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